11
ACHIEVING ATMANIRBHARTA

12 MAY 2020

INDIA | 47,451 ACTIVE CASES | 2,421 DEATHS

WORLD | 23,06,351 ACTIVE CASES | 3,18,011 DEATHS

All arms of the government, including our Armed Forces had put in night and day to ensure that supply chains of essential items were maintained and healthcare infrastructure significantly updated. Over 588 flights were operated under the Lifeline Udan mission to make sure that even remote corners of the country were not left out of the supply of essentials.[1] We had become self-sufficient in the production of essential medicines, N95 masks, PPE gear as well as ventilators. We had successfully evacuated all Indian citizens who wanted to return home. Time had now come for the country to reopen. Economic measures were put in place and structural changes planned.

The prime minister, after months of cautionary messages, addressed the nation with a message of hope and renewal.[2] Ever since he was voted in as prime minister with a large majority in 2014 and an even larger one in 2019, he has commanded authority from all sides of the political spectrum as a man who could bring drastic changes to catalyse India's growth story. The fact that he presents himself devoid of worldly attachments and as the foremost patriot and a full-time prime minister adds to his credibility. Millions of Indians invest their emotions in his dreams of taking India's growth story to new heights. In his speech on 12 May, he delivered precisely that—his dream for a new, post-COVID, stronger India with a solid plan to achieve it, invoking a rejuvenated spirit of patriotism.

He noted in his speech,